

The Four-Layer Question Framework

Every analytical question lives at one of four layers. The value compounds as you climb.

1 DESCRIPTIVE “What happened?” <i>The dashboard layer. Reports facts about the past.</i>	GIVES YOU A snapshot. A photograph of a moment in time. DOES NOT GIVE No explanation. No direction. No decision.	GKFG-SHAPED EXAMPLES - How many customers did GK One add last quarter? - What is the NPL rate in our western Jamaica branches today?
2 DIAGNOSTIC “Why did it happen?” <i>The explanation layer. Requires a hypothesis.</i>	GIVES YOU A candidate explanation, testable against further data. DOES NOT GIVE No certainty about the future. No recommendation.	GKFG-SHAPED EXAMPLES - Why did GK One adoption plateau in Guyana while it grew in Jamaica? - Why did combined ratio deteriorate — Melissa, or underlying frequency?
3 PREDICTIVE “What will happen next?” <i>The forecast layer. Requires a model.</i>	GIVES YOU A range of plausible futures, each with assumptions surfaced. DOES NOT GIVE No recommendation. A forecast is not a decision.	GKFG-SHAPED EXAMPLES - When will GK One reach 50% penetration of FGB transacting customers in Guyana? - What does combined ratio look like under a 1-in-10-year event next season?
4 PRESCRIPTIVE “What should we do?” <i>The decision layer. The seat the executive earns.</i>	GIVES YOU A recommendation, traceable through the layers below. DOES NOT GIVE No guarantees. Judgment and institutional context are irreducible here.	GKFG-SHAPED EXAMPLES - Should we reallocate Q1 product capacity to a Guyana-specific onboarding fix, or hold? - Expand, hold, or contract small-business lending in western Jamaica — under what conditions would we reverse?

THE LINE TO REMEMBER

“A KPI is a Layer 1 answer. A decision lives at Layer 4. The gap between them is the executive’s job.”

WHERE THIS THREADS THROUGH SESSION 1

MODULE 2 KPI Heatmap

MODULE 3 Dashboard walkthrough

MODULE 4 Reframing exercise

MODULE 5 3 questions to ask

· gap between “watch” and “wish” is a layer gap

· climb descriptive → comparative → strategic

· every reframe is a layer climb

· protect Layer 1 from being read as Layer 4

Keep this on your table for all of Session 1.